

Items from the Situational Test of Emotional Understanding (STEU)**Reference:**

Allen, V. D., Weissman, A., Hellwig, S., MacCann, C., & Roberts, R. D. (2014). Development of the Situational Test of Emotional Understanding – Brief (STEU-B) using Item Response Theory. *Personality and Individual Differences*, 65, 3-7. [[Short Form](#)]

MacCann, C., & Roberts, R. D. (2008). New Paradigms for Assessing Emotional Intelligence: Theory and Data. *Emotion*, 8, 540-551. [[Long Form](#)]

Description of test. This test assesses emotion understanding, a key component of emotional intelligence. In each item, the test-taker is required to choose which of five emotions is most likely to result from an emotional situation. The long form consists of 42 items and the short form consist of 19 items.

Test development. Roseman's (2001) appraisal theory was as the basis for item construction and scoring of the STEU. For more information on test development, see MacCann and Roberts (2008).

Reliability. This Cronbach's alpha for the short form of this test is .63 (Allen et al., 2013).

Instructions

The following questions each describe a situation, and ask you to choose which of five emotions is most likely to result from that situation.

Here is an example:

Clara receives a gift. Clara is most likely to feel?

(a) happy (b) angry (c) frightened (d) bored (e) hungry

If you think Clara would feel happy, you would mark option A and then move to the next question. There are 19 questions.

Test items

1. Xavier completes a difficult task on time and under budget. *Xavier is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Surprise
- (b) Pride
- (c) Relief
- (d) Hope
- (e) Joy

2. If the current situation continues, Denise's employer will probably be able to move her job to a location much closer to her home, which she really wants. *Denise is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Distress
- (b) Joy
- (c) Surprise
- (d) Hope
- (e) Fear

3. Song finds out that a friend of hers has borrowed money from others to pay urgent bills, but has in fact used the money for less serious purposes. *Song is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Anger

- (b) Excitement
- (c) Contempt
- (d) Shame
- (e) Horror

4. Charles is meeting a friend to see a movie. The friend is very late and they are not in time to make it to the movie. *Charles is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Depressed
- (b) Frustrated
- (c) Angry
- (d) Contemptuous
- (e) Distressed

5. Someone believes that another person harmed them on purpose. There is not a lot that can be done to make things better. *The person involved is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Dislike
- (b) Rage
- (c) Jealousy
- (d) Surprise
- (e) Anxiety

6. Jim enjoys spending Saturdays playing with his children in the park. This year they have sporting activities on Saturdays and cannot go to the park with him any more. *Jim is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Angry
- (b) Sad
- (c) Frustrated
- (d) Distressed
- (e) Ashamed

7. Megan is looking to buy a house. Something happened and she felt regret. *What is most likely to have happened?*

- (a) She didn't make an offer on a house she wanted, and now she is trying to find out if it is too late.
- (b) She found a house she liked that she didn't think she would find.
- (c) She couldn't make an offer on a house she liked because the bank didn't get her the money in time.
- (d) She didn't make an offer on a house she liked and now someone else has bought it.
- (e) She made an offer on a house and is waiting to see if it is accepted.

8. Mary was working at her desk. Something happened that caused her to feel surprised. *What is most likely to have happened?*

- (a) Her work-mate told a silly joke.
- (b) She was working on a new task she hadn't dealt with before.
- (c) She found some results that were different from what she thought they would be.
- (d) She realized she would not be able to complete her work.
- (e) She had to do a task she didn't normally do at work.

9. Someone thinks that another person has deliberately caused something good to happen to them. *They are most likely to feel?*
- (a) Hope
 - (b) Pride
 - (c) Gratitude
 - (d) Surprise
 - (e) Relief
10. By their own actions, a person reaches a goal they wanted to reach. *The person is most likely to feel?*
- (a) Joy
 - (b) Hope
 - (c) Relief
 - (d) Pride
 - (e) Surprise
11. An unwanted situation becomes less likely or stops altogether. *The person involved is most likely to feel?*
- (a) Regret
 - (b) Hope
 - (c) Joy
 - (d) Sadness
 - (e) Relief
12. Hasad tries to use his new mobile phone. He has always been able to work out how to use different appliances, but he cannot get the phone to function. *Hasad is most likely to feel?*
- (a) Distressed
 - (b) Confused
 - (c) Surprised
 - (d) Relieved
 - (e) Frustrated
13. Dorian's friend is ill and coughs all over him without bothering to turn away or cover his mouth. *Dorian is most likely to feel?*
- (a) Anxiety
 - (b) Dislike
 - (c) Surprise
 - (d) Jealousy
 - (e) Rage
14. Quan and his wife are talking about what happened to them that day. Something happened that caused Quan to feel surprised. *What is most likely to have happened?*
- (a) His wife talked a lot, which did not usually happen.
 - (b) His wife talked about things that were different to what they usually discussed.
 - (c) His wife told him that she might have some bad news.
 - (d) His wife told Quan some news that was not what he thought it would be.
 - (e) His wife told a funny story.

15. A supervisor who is unpleasant to work for leaves Alfonso's work. *Alfonso is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Joy
- (b) Hope
- (c) Regret
- (d) Relief
- (e) Sadness

16. The nature of Sara's job changes due to unpredictable factors and she no longer gets to do the portions of her work that she most enjoyed. *Sara is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Ashamed
- (b) Sad
- (c) Angry
- (d) Distressed
- (e) Frustrated

17. Leila has been unable to sleep well lately and there are no changes in her life that might indicate why. *Leila is most likely to feel?*

- (a) Angry
- (b) Scared
- (c) Sad
- (d) Distressed
- (e) Guilty

18. Someone believes another person has deliberately caused something good to stop happening to them. However, they feel they can do something about it. *They are most likely to feel?*

- (a) Angry
- (b) Contemptuous
- (c) Distress
- (d) Depressed
- (e) Frustrated

19. Matthew has been at his current job for six months. Something happened that caused him to feel regret. *What is most likely to have happened?*

- (a) He did not apply for a position he wanted, and has found out that someone else less qualified got the job.
- (b) He did not apply for a position he wanted, and has started looking for a similar position.
- (c) He found out that opportunities for promotion have dried up.
- (d) He found out that he didn't get a position he thought he would get.
- (e) He didn't hear about a position he could have applied for and now it is too late.

Scoring the STEU in SPSS

The following SPSS syntax can be used to score the 19 items of the STEU. This assumes that the variable names for the items are STEU01, STEU02, STEU03, STEU04 etc up to STEU19, and that the responses are coded as A=1, B=2, C=3, D=5, and E=5.

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RECODE STEU06 (1=0) (2=1) (3=0) (4=0) (5=0) INTO STEU_R06.  
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RECODE STEU17 (1=0) (2=0) (3=0) (4=1) (5=0) INTO STEU_R17.  
RECODE STEU18 (1=1) (2=0) (3=0) (4=0) (5=0) INTO STEU_R18.  
RECODE STEU19 (1=1) (2=0) (3=0) (4=0) (5=0) INTO STEU_R19.
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